

Research on mental health sees huge boost

Driven by son's ordeal, family has given Broad over \$1b

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

The Broad Institute of MIT and Harvard is poised to receive a massive injection of cash to fund breakthroughs in the understanding and treatment of bipolar disorder and schizophrenia research.

The Stanley Family Foundation's \$280 million gift brings the Stanley family's total philanthropy to the Broad's fight against these illnesses to more than \$1 billion.

The donation represents a badly needed investment in mental health research, Broad leaders said, at a time when the federal funding landscape is on shaky ground. Last summer, the Broad laid off 75 employees, part of a belt-tightening across the state's research institutions since President Trump took office and slashed research funding.

The state's researchers ultimately lost less than feared — about \$47 million to \$100 million compared to the prior year — and some grants were restored amid lawsuits. But the chaos prompted urgency among universities to expand funding sources outside the federal government.

The Stanley's gift provides a guaranteed financial foundation for scientists to try new methods and take bigger risks to search for potential treatments without fear of disappearing funds, said Benjamin Neale, co-director of the Stanley Center for Psychiatric Research.

"Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder are

BROAD INSTITUTE, Page A6

Lawmakers' pay targeted by petitions

Restrictions sought on State House stipends

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Critics of the Massachusetts Legislature have found a new target in the name of improving government accountability: how much lawmakers make.

Activists, some former lawmakers themselves, are pushing a bid to ask voters to change how legislators earn extra money for holding leadership roles, such as committee chair, majority leader, or even House speaker. They're arguing those stipends should be determined by how much work lawmakers do, rather than leadership decisions.

If successful, their proposed ballot question would restrict stipends to a certain percentage of a legislative leader's base salary — currently set at \$82,044 — alongside other limits. This would dramatically cut legislative leaders' paychecks collectively by more than \$500,000, and some by tens of thousands of dollars alone.

That effort is drawing criticism and scrutiny from those very same elected officials, who have asked the state's top court to weigh in on the proposal's constitutionality, arguing that it could undermine the legislative rules they have the power to set.

The fight is the latest example of how transparency advocates are trying to make what they call one of the country's least transparent legislative bodies more accessible and accountable

STIPENDS, Page A10

Abortion rates surge in Mass.

Care for out-of-state patients pushes up numbers since court overturned Roe

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

In the years since the US Supreme Court's decision overturning Roe v. Wade in 2022, Massachusetts has emerged as a major national provider of abortion care, with new state data showing terminations using medication have more than doubled, and most patients receiving care are from out of state.

The increase was driven largely by the rapid expansion of telehealth

services in which providers can prescribe abortion pills, as well as a surge of patients traveling from states that imposed tighter restrictions following the Supreme Court decision.

The shift has been so pronounced that patients from other states now outnumber Massachusetts residents seeking abortion care.

"The state is playing a huge role in ensuring that abortion seekers

throughout the country get the care they want, need, and deserve," said Dr. Angel Foster, a physician with Cambridge Reproductive Health Consultants, which serves a significant number of telehealth patients through the Massachusetts Medication Abortion Access Project, or MAP.

According to data published by the Massachusetts Department of Public Health in December, there were 49,450 abortions in 2024, up from 24,355 in 2023 — a 103 percent increase. Much of that was largely from a dramatic increase in remote access to abortion medica-

tion, which has rapidly become the primary method statewide.

Telehealth abortions accounted for 30,900 cases in 2024, or about 62 percent — a steep climb from 5,745 cases in 2023, the first time the state began documenting telehealth.

Medication abortions, typically involving the drug mifepristone, represented more than 60 percent of all procedures, with surgical methods a smaller share.

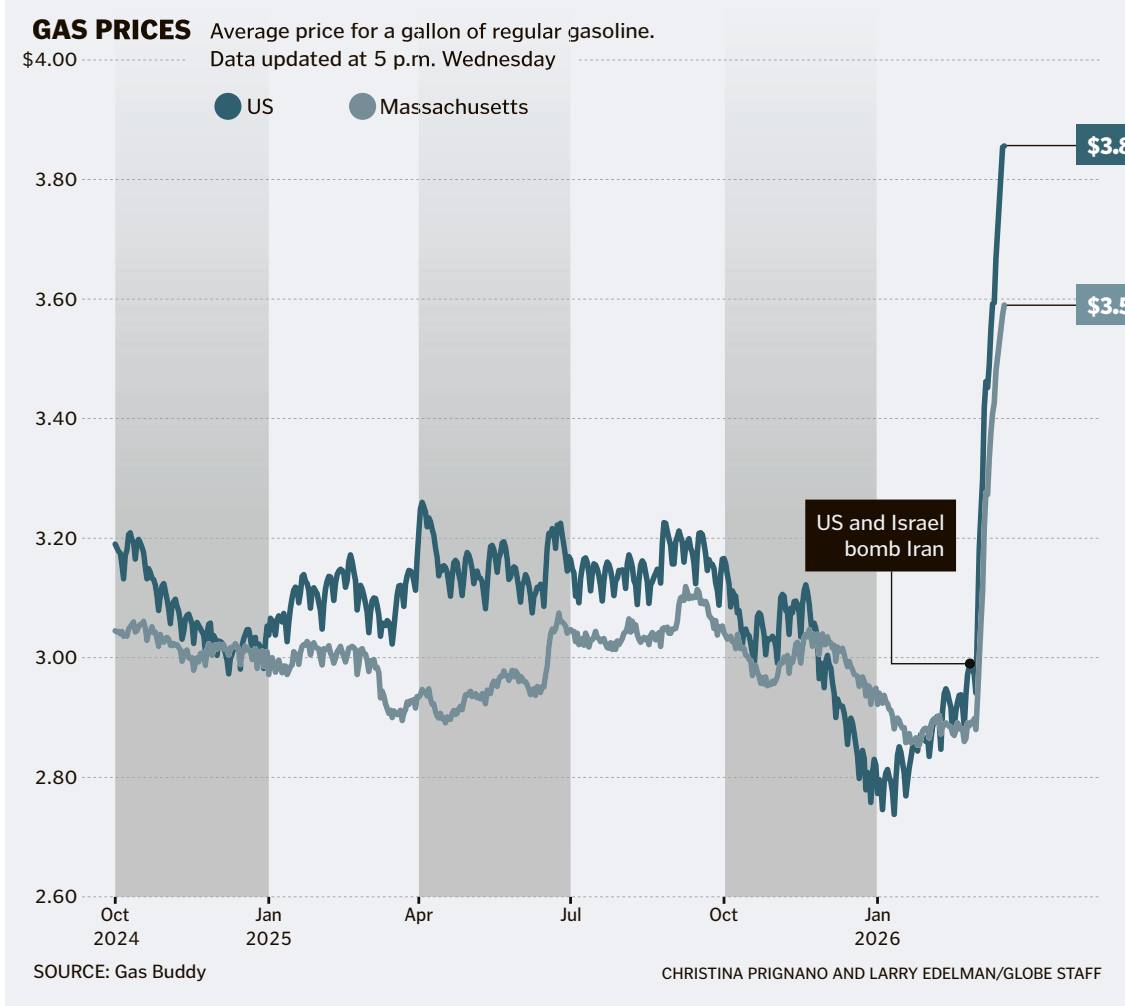
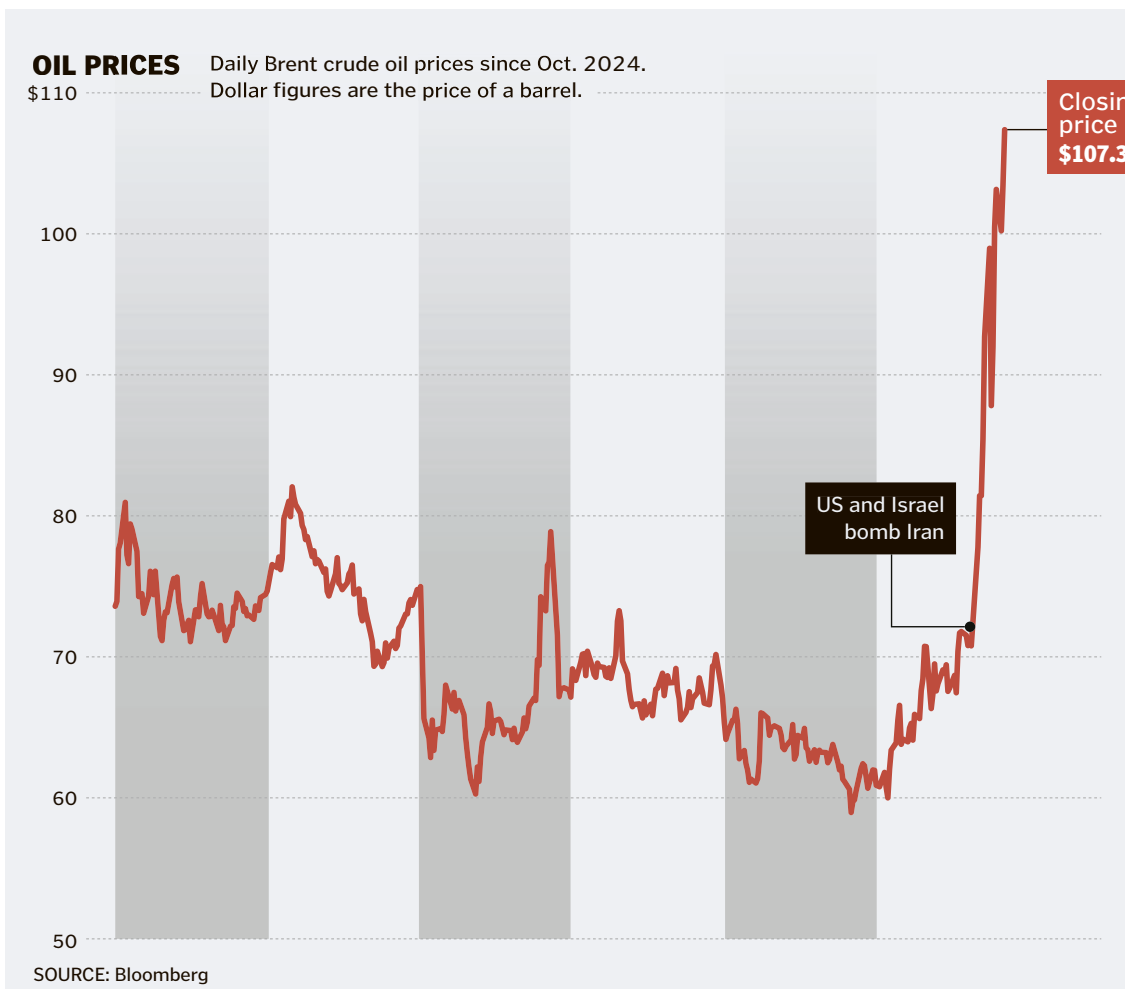
The shift is a result of ongoing national debate over abortion access and the regulation of medication.

ABORTIONS, Page A6

COST OF WAR COMES HOME

OIL & GAS | Oil and natural gas prices spiked again after airstrikes hit major energy facilities for Iran in the Persian Gulf. **A4.**

IRAN | Tulsi Gabbard, US director of national intelligence, said that Iran's regime "appears to be intact but largely degraded." **A5.**



Getting real about opposition to AI 'slop'

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

What finally pushed University of Massachusetts Dartmouth student Caitlyn Harrington over the edge was a post on Instagram. That it showed her campus in full summer bloom despite it being the dead of winter was irritating enough. Then she looked more closely.

The circular building it depicted in the background did not actually exist. The logo in the corner, well-known to students, was garbled. A rendering of the campus mascot, the Corsair, was all wrong.

"He's blind. His earring is cut in half. He's not the right colors. He's . . . weird," Harrington said. "I could tell it was AI right away."

It was the kind of image that is known these days as "AI slop," low-effort writing, artwork, or videos made by typing prompts into generative AI tools. As "slop" appears in more places and for more purposes, a local cohort of students, artists, and AI skeptics are trying to keep artificial imagery out of politics, publishing, advertising, and anywhere else it might replace human-made, public-facing artwork with what they see as robot-made junk.

"This isn't just a fun little tool we get to play around with.

AI SLOP, Page A10



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Chavez abused girls, report says

While working to help immigrant farmworkers, he assaulted women and girls, an investigation found. **A2.**

A face in the cloud

Thursday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 40-45. Low: 32-37.

Friday: Sun then clouds. High: 49-54. Low: 39-44.

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

The Blackstone Valley Schools co-op hockey team beat Lincoln High School in quadruple overtime to win a Rhode Island hockey title, weeks after a shooting at a Pawtucket ice rink shattered the team's "Senior Night" game. B1.

Cuban President Miguel Díaz-Canel lashed out after President Trump said that he can do "whatever he wants" with the Caribbean island and that Washington could take "imminent action" against it. A3.

Move for synthetic turf at school field raises worries on Nantucket

Opponents fear student exposure to pollutants

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

NANTUCKET — The spring season for lacrosse is just starting, but the sports field at Nantucket High is empty of athletes, its grass field scarred with divots and streaks of mud.

School officials and the athletics community want to replace the battered field, also used for football games, with artificial turf. But in a twist on an old concern about the safety of fake grass, some parents worry the synthetic turf is stuffed with chemicals that pose a risk to their children as they run, dive, and roll on it.

On Thursday, the Nantucket Board of Health is expected to

weigh whether to ban synthetic turf, not just from the playing field, but entirely from the island. If it does, Nantucket would be the latest of a small number of Massachusetts communities that have rejected artificial grass as part of a broader reckoning over toxic pollutants in everyday consumer products that have become nearly impossible to avoid.

"The direction that the sci-

TURF, Page A7